



Laser Peripheral Iridotomy (LPI)

Laser peripheral iridotomy (LPI) is a procedure used to treat or prevent angle-closure glaucoma. It uses a focused laser to create a tiny hole in the iris (colored part of the eye), allowing fluid to flow more freely and reducing eye pressure.

Why Is It Done?

LPI is typically recommended for patients who:

- Have narrow drainage angles
- Are at risk for angle-closure glaucoma
- Have already experienced a sudden pressure spike (acute angle closure)

It helps create a new pathway for fluid inside the eye, which can relieve pressure and prevent vision loss.

What to Expect During the Procedure

- LPI is done in a clinic or laser room
- Eye drops will be used to constrict your pupil and numb your eye
- A special contact lens is placed on your eye to help focus the laser
- The laser makes a small hole in your iris — this takes only a few minutes
- You may feel a pinch or a light sting

After the Procedure

- Your eye pressure will be checked shortly afterward
- You may receive anti-inflammatory eye drops for a few days
- Vision may be blurry or light-sensitive temporarily
- Some people see small shadows or light streaks that fade with time

Possible Side Effects

LPI is generally safe, but like any procedure, there are risks:

- Temporary blurred vision or discomfort
- Inflammation (treated with drops)
- Light sensitivity or glare
- In rare cases, increased eye pressure or bleeding



Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Is LPI painful?

A: Most patients feel only mild discomfort — the laser itself is fast and usually not painful.

Q: Will I still need glaucoma medications?

A: Possibly. LPI helps with angle anatomy, but may not replace the need for eye drops or other treatment.

Q: Will I need LPI in both eyes?

A: If both eyes have narrow angles, your doctor may recommend LPI in both — sometimes on the same day or a few weeks apart.

Q: Does the hole stay open forever?

A: In most cases, yes. Rarely, the hole can close and may need to be reopened.